

Art Intermediate 3 Major Assessments Guide

The Young Artist Museum Passport | 32 Weeks | 64 Lessons

Assessment Design Purpose

These major assessments are designed to measure more than written recall. Students should show whether they can observe carefully, use art vocabulary, interpret artworks and utilitarian objects, plan and revise, apply techniques, make original artistic choices, and explain the intentions behind their work.

Course question: How do artists across time use tools, materials, symbols, design, and imagination to communicate what matters?

Expected rigor: Grade 5 assessments emphasize evidence-based observation, intentional design choices, craftsmanship, revision, cultural and historical connection, and clear artist statements.

Recommended Assessment Pattern

Component	What It Measures	Suggested Weight
Observation / Source Study	Ability to look closely at an artwork, artifact, image, or utilitarian object and use visible evidence to interpret choices and purpose.	20-25%
Studio Performance	Ability to apply the taught element, principle, technique, process, or design challenge in original artwork.	30-40%
Process / Planning / Revision	Ability to sketch, plan, follow sequential procedures, apply criteria, and improve work before submission.	15-20%
Artist Statement / Reflection	Ability to explain motivation, intention, cultural or historical connection, vocabulary, and personal choices.	15-20%
Craftsmanship and Presentation	Ability to use materials responsibly, complete work carefully, photograph or present it clearly, and meet requirements.	10-15%

Major Assessments At a Glance

Quarter	Weeks	Assessment	Primary Evidence/Product	Main Standards Clusters	Passport / Portfolio Connection
Q1	1-4	Museum Observer and Elements Check	Students analyze a public-domain artwork, identify line/shape/color choices, and create a small composition that uses two art elements intentionally.	VA.5.C.1.2, VA.5.C.3.1, VA.5.O.1.1, VA.5.S.1.4	Look Closely; Art Vocabulary; Artist Statement
Q1	5-8	Artist Toolbox Portfolio Assessment	Students choose or create work showing color, value, texture, and careful craftsmanship. They explain how a visual element changes meaning or effect.	VA.5.C.2.1, VA.5.C.2.2, VA.5.C.2.3, VA.5.S.1.1, VA.5.S.3.2	Studio Practice; Portfolio Check; Revision Artist
Q2	9-12	Ancient Art as Evidence Assessment	Students explain how ancient artworks and utilitarian objects show beliefs, identity, communication, and daily life. Students plan an original artwork inspired by ancient evidence.	VA.5.C.3.2, VA.5.H.1.1, VA.5.H.1.3, VA.5.O.2.1, VA.5.S.1.3	Art as Evidence; Look Closely; Museum Passport Notes
Q2	13-16	Classical Design and Function Assessment	Students compare Greek design examples and create a design that uses symmetry, pattern, proportion, or column structure to communicate order and purpose.	VA.5.H.2.1, VA.5.H.2.2, VA.5.O.1.2, VA.5.S.2.1, VA.5.S.2.3	Compare Across Time; Design Plan; Studio Practice
Q3	17-20	Architecture and Mosaic Evidence Assessment	Students demonstrate understanding of architecture as art and public design by identifying required features, explaining function, and applying careful visual organization.	VA.5.C.2.1, VA.5.C.3.3, VA.5.H.2.2, VA.5.H.2.3, VA.5.F.2.2, VA.5.S.3.1	Project Planning; Progress Check; Art Criticism; Revision Artist
Q3	21-24	Symbols and Sacred Design Portfolio	Students use symbols, lettering, pattern, color,	VA.5.C.1.3, VA.5.C.2.2, VA.5.F.1.2, VA.5.O.3.1,	Symbol Study; Studio Practice; Artist Statement;

Quarter	Weeks	Assessment	Primary Evidence/Product	Main Standards Clusters	Passport / Portfolio Connection
		Assessment	and composition to communicate identity, values, or meaning in a refined final design.	VA.5.S.2.2, VA.5.S.3.2	Critique Criteria
Q4	25-28	Design, Function, and Personal Voice Assessment	Students explain how art can be useful, decorative, narrative, and personal, then create or select work that communicates meaning through design choices.	VA.5.H.2.2, VA.5.F.2.3, VA.5.F.3.2, VA.5.O.3.1, VA.5.S.1.2	Art in Daily Life; Personal Voice; Look Closely; Studio Reflection
Q4	29-32	Young Artist Museum Final Exhibition	Students synthesize the course by creating a final artwork inspired by a studied tradition, skill, or museum wing and explaining its artistic and historical connection.	VA.5.C.2.3, VA.5.F.1.2, VA.5.O.2.2, VA.5.O.3.1, VA.5.S.1.3, VA.5.S.3.4	Portfolio Curator; Final Exhibition; Artist Statement; Art as Evidence

Assessment Descriptions

Q1 Weeks 1-4: Museum Observer and Elements Check

Timing: After Week 4

Recommended format: Image observation, vocabulary match, elements identification, and small design task.

Evidence of learning: Students analyze a public-domain artwork, identify line/shape/color choices, and create a small composition that uses two art elements intentionally.

Standards focus: VA.5.C.1.2, VA.5.C.3.1, VA.5.O.1.1, VA.5.S.1.4

Primary museum routines assessed: Look Closely; Art Vocabulary; Artist Statement

Art focus: Observation, art vocabulary, elements of art, and first evidence-based interpretation.

Assessment Component	Student Evidence
Look Closely Task	Students answer observation prompts about one anchor image and cite visible evidence.
Vocabulary and Elements Check	Students match or identify key terms such as line, shape, color, composition, and mood.
Mini Design Task	Students create a small abstract or representational design using line, shape, and color intentionally.
Artist Explanation	Students explain one visual choice and the effect they wanted it to have.

Success criteria: A successful response identifies visible details, uses art vocabulary accurately, creates a purposeful design, and explains choices with evidence.

Q1 Weeks 5-8: Artist Toolbox Portfolio Assessment

Timing: After Week 8

Recommended format: Portfolio selection, studio performance, technique self-check, and short artist statement.

Evidence of learning: Students choose or create work showing color, value, texture, and careful craftsmanship. They explain how a visual element changes meaning or effect.

Standards focus: VA.5.C.2.1, VA.5.C.2.2, VA.5.C.2.3, VA.5.S.1.1, VA.5.S.3.2

Primary museum routines assessed: Studio Practice; Portfolio Check; Revision Artist

Art focus: Color, value, texture, craftsmanship, revision, and personal artistic decision-making.

Assessment Component	Student Evidence
Portfolio Evidence	Students submit selected work from color, value, texture, or dragon eye lessons.
Technique Task	Students demonstrate value or texture in a new small study or revision.
Revision Note	Students identify one improvement they made or would make.
Artist Statement	Students explain how their use of color, value, or texture affects the final work.

Success criteria: A successful portfolio shows technique, effortful improvement, and a clear explanation of how art choices affect the finished work.

Q2 Weeks 9-12: Ancient Art as Evidence Assessment

Timing: After Week 12

Recommended format: Artifact/image analysis, cultural context task, symbol design plan, and short claim-evidence response.

Evidence of learning: Students explain how ancient artworks and utilitarian objects show beliefs, identity, communication, and daily life. Students plan an original artwork inspired by ancient evidence.

Standards focus: VA.5.C.3.2, VA.5.H.1.1, VA.5.H.1.3, VA.5.O.2.1, VA.5.S.1.3

Primary museum routines assessed: Art as Evidence; Look Closely; Museum Passport Notes

Art focus: Cave art, Egyptian cartouches, Egyptian pottery, symbolism, function, and historical/cultural meaning.

Assessment Component	Student Evidence
Anchor Image Analysis	Students study a cave painting, cartouche, or vessel and identify visual evidence of purpose or meaning.
Culture and Function Chart	Students sort details into categories: communication, identity, daily life, ceremony, or belief.
Design Plan	Students sketch or plan a cave-art, cartouche, or pottery-inspired design with historically informed choices.
Claim-Evidence Response	Students answer: How can art serve as evidence of what mattered to a culture?

Success criteria: A successful assessment connects visible details to cultural meaning and uses historical inspiration ethically in an original design plan.

Q2 Weeks 13-16: Classical Design and Function Assessment

Timing: After Week 16

Recommended format: Visual comparison, Greek design vocabulary, symmetrical design task, and functional art explanation.

Evidence of learning: Students compare Greek design examples and create a design that uses symmetry, pattern, proportion, or column structure to communicate order and purpose.

Standards focus: VA.5.H.2.1, VA.5.H.2.2, VA.5.O.1.2, VA.5.S.2.1, VA.5.S.2.3

Primary museum routines assessed: Compare Across Time; Design Plan; Studio Practice

Art focus: Greek vases, Greek columns, functional art, symmetry, harmony, pattern, and architecture.

Assessment Component	Student Evidence
Visual Comparison	Students compare a vase, temple, or column image and identify style/design features.
Vocabulary Check	Students use terms such as symmetry, pattern, functional art, harmony, column, and terracotta.
Design Task	Students create or revise a Greek-inspired vase or temple

Assessment Component	Student Evidence
	design with required structural features.
Purpose Explanation	Students explain how their object or building design has function, beauty, or symbolic purpose.

Success criteria: A successful design uses classical visual features intentionally and explains how structure, decoration, and function work together.

Q3 Weeks 17-20: Architecture and Mosaic Evidence Assessment

Timing: After Week 20

Recommended format: Colosseum project evidence, architecture feature check, mosaic/source observation, and improvement reflection.

Evidence of learning: Students demonstrate understanding of architecture as art and public design by identifying required features, explaining function, and applying careful visual organization.

Standards focus: VA.5.C.2.1, VA.5.C.3.3, VA.5.H.2.2, VA.5.H.2.3, VA.5.F.2.2, VA.5.S.3.1

Primary museum routines assessed: Project Planning; Progress Check; Art Criticism; Revision Artist

Art focus: Roman Colosseum, public architecture, arches, levels, labels, function, and mosaic design.

Assessment Component	Student Evidence
Architecture Evidence	Students identify at least three architectural features in their Colosseum project or a source image.
Function Explanation	Students explain how the structure was designed for public use.
Mosaic Observation	Students analyze how small parts combine into a larger symbolic image.
Revision Reflection	Students describe one improvement made during planning, progress, or final work.

Success criteria: A successful assessment shows architectural detail, explains purpose, and demonstrates revision based on criteria.

Q3 Weeks 21-24: Symbols and Sacred Design Portfolio Assessment

Timing: After Week 24

Recommended format: Illuminated letter or calligraphy sample, heraldry shield, symbol key, and artist statement.

Evidence of learning: Students use symbols, lettering, pattern, color, and composition to communicate identity, values, or meaning in a refined final design.

Standards focus: VA.5.C.1.3, VA.5.C.2.2, VA.5.F.1.2, VA.5.O.3.1, VA.5.S.2.2, VA.5.S.3.2

Primary museum routines assessed: Symbol Study; Studio Practice; Artist Statement; Critique Criteria

Art focus: Illuminated letters, calligraphy, heraldry, symbolic design, craftsmanship, and personal voice.

Assessment Component	Student Evidence
Symbol Key	Students identify the symbols, colors, and shapes they chose and explain their meanings.

Assessment Component	Student Evidence
Studio Product	Students submit an illuminated initial, calligraphy piece, heraldry shield, or combined portfolio evidence.
Craftsmanship Check	Students evaluate neatness, spacing, pattern, color, and completion.
Artist Statement	Students explain how the design communicates identity, value, belief, or purpose.

Success criteria: A successful portfolio uses symbolic choices intentionally, shows care in craft, and explains meaning clearly.

Q4 Weeks 25-28: Design, Function, and Personal Voice Assessment

Timing: After Week 28

Recommended format: Design analysis, functional/decorative art task, personal-symbolism artwork, and reflective explanation.

Evidence of learning: Students explain how art can be useful, decorative, narrative, and personal, then create or select work that communicates meaning through design choices.

Standards focus: VA.5.H.2.2, VA.5.F.2.3, VA.5.F.3.2, VA.5.O.3.1, VA.5.S.1.2

Primary museum routines assessed: Art in Daily Life; Personal Voice; Look Closely; Studio Reflection

Art focus: Blue Willow, still life, dream room, detailed scene, tints/shades, symbolism, mood, and personal voice.

Assessment Component	Student Evidence
Design Analysis	Students analyze a functional object or detailed scene and identify pattern, story, color, or symbolism.
Studio Product	Students submit a Blue Willow design, symbolic still life, dream room, or detailed scene.
Choice Explanation	Students explain how their design choices communicate personal meaning or mood.
Art in Daily Life Response	Students answer how art affects everyday objects, spaces, or communities.

Success criteria: A successful response connects design choices to meaning, function, or personal voice and shows controlled use of art elements.

Q4 Weeks 29-32: Young Artist Museum Final Exhibition

Timing: Final Week

Recommended format: Final exhibit artwork, passport/portfolio review, title card, artist statement, and curator reflection.

Evidence of learning: Students synthesize the course by creating a final artwork inspired by a studied tradition, skill, or museum wing and explaining its artistic and historical connection.

Standards focus: VA.5.C.2.3, VA.5.F.1.2, VA.5.O.2.2, VA.5.O.3.1, VA.5.S.1.3, VA.5.S.3.4

Primary museum routines assessed: Portfolio Curator; Final Exhibition; Artist Statement; Art as Evidence

Art focus: Portfolio growth, final synthesis, original artwork, ethical inspiration, presentation, and reflection.

Assessment Component	Student Evidence
Portfolio Review	Students review passport stamps and select evidence of growth.
Final Artwork	Students create an original work inspired by one course tradition, element, skill, or cultural focus.
Exhibit Title Card	Students write title, medium, inspiration, and 2-3 vocabulary terms.
Curator Reflection	Students explain how their final work shows growth and how it connects to the course.

Success criteria: A successful final exhibition shows original art-making, course connection, vocabulary, reflection, and thoughtful presentation.

Common Rubric for Major Assessments

Criterion	Beginning	Developing	Secure
Observation and Art Criticism	Names obvious details but gives little evidence or interpretation.	Identifies relevant details and explains a basic interpretation.	Uses visible evidence and art vocabulary to form a thoughtful interpretation or hypothesis about meaning, purpose, or design.
Studio Skill and Technique	Uses the assigned skill incompletely or without control.	Uses the assigned skill with some control and meets most requirements.	Uses the assigned skill intentionally and effectively to strengthen the artwork.
Elements, Principles, and Composition	Includes elements of art but organization may be unclear.	Uses elements or principles to organize the work and communicate an idea.	Organizes elements and principles with clear focus, unity, balance, contrast, pattern, or emphasis as appropriate.
Historical, Cultural, or Functional Connection	Mentions the topic but gives little connection to the artwork.	Explains a connection between the artwork and the studied artist, culture, period, or function.	Clearly explains how the artwork is inspired by or connected to historical, cultural, functional, or community meaning.
Process, Planning, and Revision	Shows little evidence of planning or improvement.	Shows planning and at least one improvement based on criteria.	Uses planning, self-check, and revision to strengthen artistic choices and final presentation.
Artist Statement and Vocabulary	Gives a short or unclear explanation with limited vocabulary.	Explains choices using some accurate art vocabulary.	Clearly explains intention, choices, process, and meaning using accurate art vocabulary.
Craftsmanship, Materials, and Presentation	Work appears rushed, incomplete, unsafe, or hard to view.	Work is complete and presented clearly with adequate care.	Work is complete, carefully crafted, responsibly made, and clearly photographed or presented.

Assessment Cadence and Canvas Use

Each quarter includes two major assessments. The first assessment in a quarter usually checks transfer of recent learning, while the second functions as a portfolio, project, or synthesis assessment. Each assessment should be short enough to complete independently but rich enough to show the standards being taught.

In Canvas, each assessment should include all needed images, source excerpts, directions, planning boxes, checklists, and response prompts. Do not require a video to understand the assessment. Whenever physical artwork is submitted, include directions for taking a clear photo.

Recommended item mix: one anchor image or artifact observation task, one applied studio or design task, one planning or revision check, and one artist statement. Objective vocabulary items may be included, but they should not be the main evidence of mastery.

Student-Facing Assessment Directions Template

Each assessment page may use this structure:

1. Look closely at the artwork, artifact, or example. Answer the observation questions using visible evidence.
2. Review the vocabulary and criteria for the assessment.
3. Plan your artwork or design before beginning the final version.

4. Create or revise your artwork using the required technique, element, principle, or historical inspiration.
5. Use the self-check checklist before you submit.
6. Write your artist statement explaining your choices, process, and connection to the lesson or unit.
7. Submit a clear photo or file of your work, plus any required written response.